nations are eager to expand internationally. Brazil has had the clearest domestic political motives for pursuing BRICS collaboration. After the left-leaning PT finally captured the presidency, both presidents da Silva and Rousseff found themselves obliged to disappoint many of their most fervent and articulate partisans, particularly in the all-important arena of economic policy. An explicitly left-leaning, South-South-oriented foreign policy proved helpful in retaining the PT's substantial group of sophisticated, urban, and middle-class supporters.

***Proposition 5.*** Collaboration by China with the other BRICS in financial statecraft is most likely when China can employ the other BRICS as a cover to make its offensive foreign policy choices appear more benign to the rest of the world.

and

***Proposition 6.*** Collaboration by the other four BRICS with China in financial statecraft is more likely when they perceive defensive opportunities to bind China by enticing it to cooperate with them over time. The other BRICS simultaneously expect to gain from China's rise.

The last two propositions are opposite sides of the same coin, capturing the dynamics between China and the other BRICS. China is the crucial entity within the BRICS collaboration. For China, the club is an important part of its group-making strategy to manage global governance issues. The group is useful not only to amplify China's voice and influence in global financial matters, but also to fend off criticisms from the incumbent powers and avoid pressure from them. In addition, China is now at the point where it can create multiple outside options, not only outside of the existing Bretton Woods system, but also outside of the BRICS, rendering China more able to control group dynamics in a way that enhances China's bargaining power. Since its successful recovery from the global financial crisis, economic rise to near-equal status with the United States, and subsequent emergence of President Xi, China is not very worried, either about hiding its intentions or about being tied down by its fellow BRICS. Financial statecraft, however, has become ever more interesting for China. It finds value in employing the BRICS for, inter alia, building support for RMB internationalization; pushing for a major leadership position in the IMF and G20; encouraging BRICS country institutions to cofinance with the NDB, AIIB, and OBOR; and employing this leverage to enforce and indigenize Chinese foreign investment priorities.